

WSKG



PBS



MISSION TO THE COMMUNITY



WSKG 2024 ANNUAL REPORT
TO THE COMMUNITY

IN THE COMMUNITY

Thank you for believing in our mission and supporting our public service so generously. The 2024 Annual Report is a celebration of service to the community from July 2023-June 2024 that you made possible.

LOCAL VALUE

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WSKG is a valuable part of the Southern Tier of New York and Northern Pennsylvania, providing 21 counties with reliable information, bringing local news to a wider audience, and convening conversations about important issues.

2024 KEY SERVICES

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WSKG brings drama, science, history, and the performing arts to urban and rural communities across the region.

We provide educators and caregivers in over 80 school districts with resources on early education and social/emotional learning.

WSKG reaches vulnerable populations underserved by commercial media to share important news and information.

LOCAL IMPACT

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Thank you for helping WSKG reach over a half-million households over-the-air, via streaming, and through in-person events, providing over 52,000 hours of national and locally produced news, television, and educational programming. WSKG is also grateful to partner with over 250 businesses and other nonprofit organizations to encourage community engagement in regional arts programs and to support WSKG.



*“WSKG educates, enlightens, informs and sustains me,
and I’m sure it does others as well.”*

—Rev. Nancy Lane

IN THE COMMUNITY



WSKG's mission is rooted in a commitment to serve our community with more than just video and audio content. We are a platform for those whose voices are often unheard.

Founded in 1961 as the Southern Tier Education Television Association, education is at the core of our DNA. We have always made it central to our mission, starting with our first broadcasts in 1962 from the young Roberson Museum, and continuing after the station transitioned to WSKG in 1968. This transformation aligned with the passage of the Public Television Act, signed by President Lyndon B. Johnson, which recognized the importance of public media as a tool for education and community connection. LBJ's vision was to provide free, non-commercial programming for all Americans, and WSKG is proud to carry that torch, ensuring that people from all walks of life, especially those who may not have a platform, are given a voice.

Our mission is more than that of a broadcaster; we are a community resource, offering meaningful content that educates, informs, and uplifts. In every program we produce and distribute, we remain dedicated to connecting, serving, and reflecting the diverse needs of our region.

WSKG

STORIES OF IMPACT

Highlighting Local Arts & Culture

Our award-winning show Expressions took its act on the road, visiting venues around the region to capture the performances of local artists.



Connecting Local & National News

WSKG's News Department provides coverage throughout our entire 21-county broadcast region. Through our relationship with the community, we're able to provide in-depth coverage of local stories that explores the impact these events have on those who are most affected.



Documenting Regional History

Alonzo's Ghost is an original documentary that explores the rich history of Roberson Mansion, its creator, and the stories that surround it. Amidst whispers of lingering spirits, the film seeks to uncover the truth behind the home's rumored ghosts. This engaging documentary blends the mansion's historical significance with a touch of mystery, giving viewers a unique peek into the past and the tales that still echo within its walls.



STORIES OF IMPACT

Youth Voices

WSKG collaborated with the 4-H UNITY program on a podcast initiative highlighting the voices of local students. The station has provided a media platform for a group of 14-18 year old UNITY Teen Leaders from the Union-Endicott School District to educate the community on issues impacting today's youth. These students created **The Other Side** podcast, a discussion forum for youth mental health and other social issues.

They worked with WSKG News and Education staff to record podcasts and public service announcements, identifying and researching issues. Season One of **The Other Side** debuted in December 2023 and has received widespread exposure.

Student Writing Challenge

WSKG Student Writing Challenge celebrated its 25th anniversary in 2024. This unique contest invites students from our 21-county viewing area to showcase their writing skills.

With over 550 entries, selecting the top winners in each grade level proved to be a challenge. We honored winners at a reception celebrating them, their families, teachers, and their craft. The Student Writing Challenge's collaboration with Tri Cities Opera transformed winning entries into captivating "pocket operas," showcased as part of TCO's celebrated Pocket Opera Project and recorded for broadcast on Expressions, our Arts & Culture program.



Thank you so much for all the work you put into organizing the Student Writing Challenge! The whole event was beautiful, inspiring, and very exciting! It was so wonderful to put faces to the voices we hear so often and see how some of the broadcasting works.

For me personally, it was a truly magical and empowering experience! Hearing my poem read out loud was incredible, a dream come true, to be honest. And none of that would be possible without you. So, thank you. Thank you for believing in us, even when we don't believe in ourselves. Thank you for making nights like that possible. Thank you for the hours you put into it and thank you for making it such a special night for each one of us.

—Margarite Wurtz, Student Writing Challenge Participant

SUMMARY



“WSKG gave me so much more information. It’s so important to have this type of local reporting in our region. Keep it up!” – Katherine Mead, Membership & Grants Manager, Rockwell Museum

Through fun hands-on activities and crafts, as well as PBS clips from engaging shows such as Alma’s Way, the families that participated had a fantastic, positive experience that created memories that I’m sure they will cherish for years to come. As we know play is fundamental in a child’s learning process and one of the simple activities that promote early literacy.

— Tammy Sickmon, Youth Services Librarian, Cortland Free Library

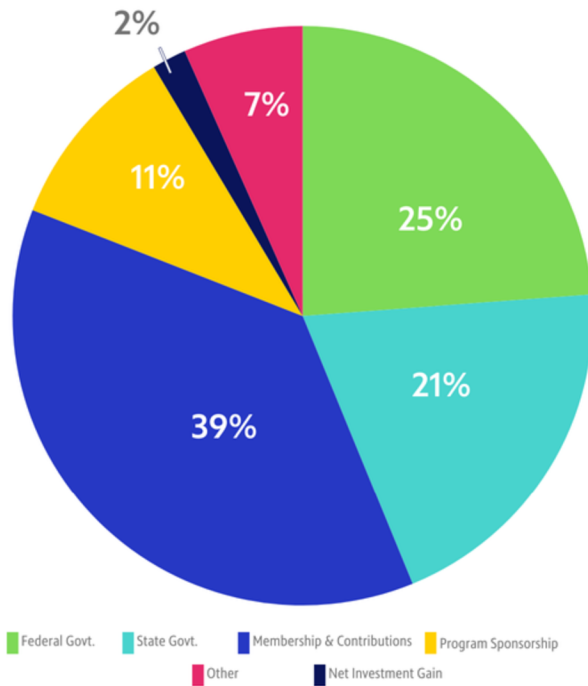


WSKG Coffee & Conversation – A fireside chat with NPR’s David Folkenflik hosted by WSKG’s Tom Magnarelli and Crystal Sarakas. This public event focused on the role of local news in media.

WSKG connects the communities we serve, lifting the voices of our region, and providing vital news, arts, education, and culture that’s free and accessible to anyone, anywhere, any time.

FINANCIALS

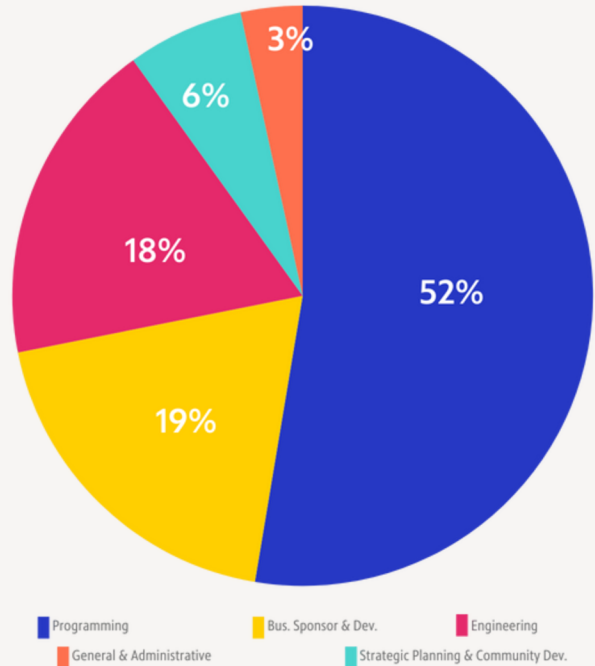
WSKG FY 24 REVENUE



Federal Government	\$1,327,231
State Government	\$1,102,103
Membership & Contributions	\$2,145,244
Program Sponsorship	\$ 598,825
Net Investment Gain	\$ 112,385
Other	\$389,133
Loss from Centralcast LLC	-\$ (145,380)

Total: \$5,529,541.00

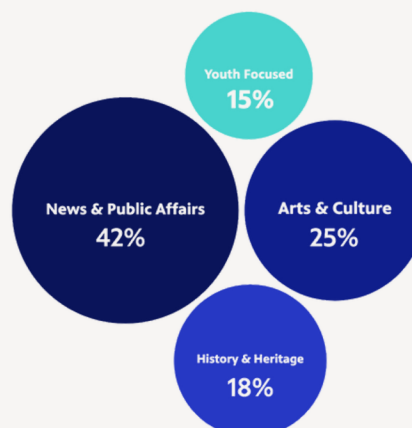
WSKG FY 24 EXPENSES



Programming	\$3,262,151
Bus. Sponsor & Dev.	\$1,197,960
Engineering	\$1,151,747
Strategic Planning & Com. Dev.	\$397,836
General & Administrative	\$213,701

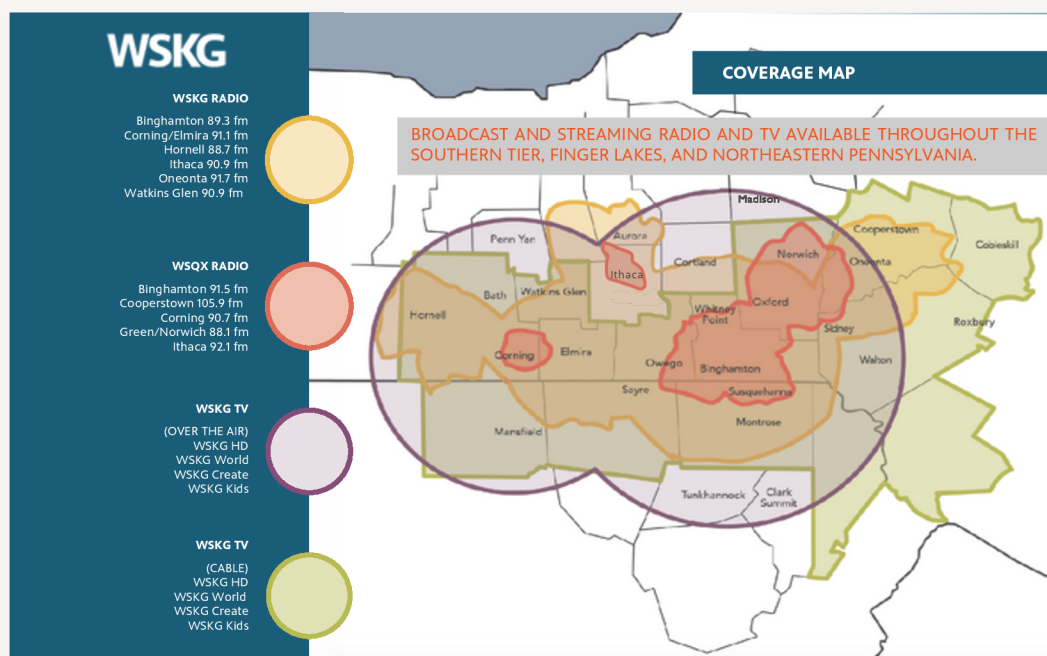
Total: \$6,223,395

WSKG FY 24 PROGRAMMING EXPENSES



Total: \$3,262,151

ABOUT



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ABOUT

Many of WSKG TV Original Productions are available on the WSKG Video Portal. Receive updates, info and interact with the station on Facebook, Twitter, Instagram @WSKGpubmedia and Pinterest or via our [online contact form](#)

WSKG is operated by WSKG Public Telecommunications Council, a private non-profit corporation chartered by the Board of Regents of the University of the State of New York in association with the New York State Department of Education, and provides a public educational telecommunications service under the governance of a Board of Trustees which is selected from the communities served by the Station.

WSKG is a community licensee and is authorized by the FCC to operate television and radio broadcasting services.

WSKG is located at 601 Gates Road, Suite 4, Vestal, NY 13850.

WSKG provides a public broadcasting service to residents of the Station's coverage area. To accomplish this WSKG produces programs locally and purchases programs from Public Broadcasting Service (PBS), American Public Television (APT), National Public Radio (NPR), and American Public Media, Public Radio International and others. WSKG then promotes these programs to the public through this web site, email, other publications, use of the stations' own air time, and through other media.

WSKG seeks educational, social and cultural concerns to address through public telecommunications in cooperation with others... and does so through the Community Advisory Board, featuring listeners & viewers from various communities in WSKG's coverage area.

